

COMPARISON · SPLIT · STRUCTURE

# split-compare

Two options + verdict — dark frame on the left, 2-column option grid + accent verdict bar on the right.

DECISION REQUIRED

## Build the data layer or buy it?

Both paths are viable. The difference is where we spend the next 18 months.

### BUILD IN-HOUSE

- Full control over schema and roadmap
- 2-3 engineer-quarters to reach feature parity
- Ongoing maintenance burden stays internal

### BUY + CONFIGURE

- Ship in 6 weeks, not 9 months
- Engineering capacity redirects to product-layer features
- Exit risk manageable — data export contractually guaranteed

RECOMMENDATION

**Buy the infrastructure. Build the differentiation. Revisit in 24 months.**

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## When NOT to reach for split-compare.

**Three or more options.** split-compare is strictly two — first card is the alternative, second card is the preferred. For three options, use `verdict-grid` or successive `decision` slides.

**No verdict.** The blockquote is mandatory. Without it the slide collapses to a comparison without a call — use `compare-prose` for that case.

**Preferred on the left.** Layout convention pins the preferred option to the second (right) card. Putting the recommendation first breaks the reading flow and the accent badge lands on the wrong card.

# See also.

## *RELATED COMPONENTS*

- `compare-prose` — the comparison is undecided — no verdict bar yet
- `decision` — the verdict slide that follows a separate comparison
- `split-brief` — the right side is findings, not paired options
- `verdict-grid` — three or more options scored against shared criteria